

A GREAT FEAST

The joust is over, and the lord and lady of the castle sit down to enjoy a sumptuous feast with their guests. The Great Hall is noisy and full. People shout to be heard over the music, dogs wait for scraps, and wine flows freely. The lord and lady have planned to impress tonight—their best tableware is on display, along with the finest food.

Salt cellar

Grand tables always had a salt cellar. Salt was highly treasured, and the dish holding it was the fanciest item on the table. Some were shaped like a ship, such as this golden three-master.



3 Dining partners share a plate or a trencher—a thick slice of bread that is used as a plate to hold food. It was considered very bad manners to eat the trencher.

Medieval music

Musicians were hired to entertain guests. During the medieval period, music began to be written down in the way that is familiar to us today, and musicians experimented with new instruments. The most popular stringed instrument was the lute, which is similar to the modern guitar.

4 Musicians are livening up the meal and, later, there will be dancing, too.



1 Stone castles were always a bit cold, but a roaring fire kept the guests cozy.

2 Tall, pointy hats, inspired by slender Gothic church spires, were the height of fashion at this time.

